

Nicolás de la Cerda

CONTACT INFORMATION	Department of Political Science University of New Mexico 2074 Social Sciences Building Albuquerque, New Mexico, 87131	✉ ndelacerda@unm.edu ☎ +1 (919) 360 0431 🌐 nicolasdelacerda.com Updated: August 18, 2026
APPOINTMENTS	University of New Mexico , Albuquerque, New Mexico Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science <i>2026-</i> Tulane University , New Orleans, Louisiana Post-doctoral Fellow, Center for Inter-American Policy and Research (CIPR) <i>2024-2026</i>	
EDUCATION	University of North Carolina , Chapel Hill, North Carolina USA Ph.D., Political Science, 2024 M.A., Political Science, 2020 Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile , Santiago, Chile M.A., Sociology, 2016 B.A., Sociology, 2016	
PUBLICATIONS	de la Cerda, Nicolás and Jacob Gunderson. <i>Forthcoming</i> . “Positional Blurring in Context: How Dimensionality and Ideology Constrain Strategy”. <i>Perspectives on Politics</i> . DOI: 10.1017/S1537592726105805 . de la Cerda, Nicolás, Cecilia Martínez-Gallardo, and Jonathan Hartlyn. 2025. “Explaining Programmatic Party Appeals in Contemporary Latin America: The Differing Roles of Ideology, Particularism and Populism”. <i>Party Politics</i> . DOI: 10.1177/13540688251409367 . de la Cerda, Nicolás. 2025. “Cueing without Parties: Experimental Evidence from Peru”. <i>Political Behavior</i> . DOI: 10.1007/s11109-025-10059-x . de la Cerda, Nicolás, Ryan Bakker, Seth Jolly, Jonathan Polk, Ruth Dassonneville, Jelle Koedam, Patrick Leslie, Jill Sheppard, and Roi Zur. 2025. “A Global Scale of Economic Left-Right Party Positions: Exploring the Cross-National and Cross-Expert Perceptions of Party Placements”. <i>The Journal of Politics</i> . DOI: 10.1086/736578 . Fuller, Sam, Nicolás de la Cerda, and Jack T. Rametta. 2025. “Affect, Not Ideology: The Heterogeneous Effects of Partisan Cues on Policy Support”. <i>Political Behavior</i> . DOI: 10.1007/s11109-025-10030-w .	

de la Cerda, Nicolás, Jonathan Hartlyn, and Cecilia Martínez-Gallardo. 2024. “Ideological and Populist Bases of Partisan Responses to the COVID-19 Pandemic in Latin America”. *The Journal of Politics in Latin America*. 16(2), 252–271. DOI: [10.1177/1866802X241262326](https://doi.org/10.1177/1866802X241262326).

de la Cerda, Nicolás and Jacob Gunderson. 2024. “Are Party Families in Europe Ideologically Coherent Today?”. *European Journal of Political Research*. 63(3), 1208–1226. DOI: [10.1111/1475-6765.12638](https://doi.org/10.1111/1475-6765.12638).

Martínez-Gallardo, Cecilia, Nicolás de la Cerda, Jonathan Hartlyn, Ryan Bakker, Liesbet Hooghe, and Gary Marks. 2023. “Revisiting Party System Structuration in Latin America and Europe: Economic and Socio-Cultural Dimensions”. *Party Politics*. 29(4), 780–792. DOI: [10.1177/13540688221090604](https://doi.org/10.1177/13540688221090604).

de la Cerda, Nicolás. 2022. “Unstable Identities: The Decline of Partisanship in Contemporary Chile”. *The Journal of Politics in Latin America*. 14(1), 3–30. DOI: [10.1177/1866802X211069378](https://doi.org/10.1177/1866802X211069378).

Bargsted, Matías and Nicolás de la Cerda. 2019. “Ideological Preferences and Evolution of the Religious Cleavage in Chile, 1998–2014”. *Latin American Research Review*. 54(2), 348–365. DOI: [10.25222/larr.309](https://doi.org/10.25222/larr.309).

BOOK
CHAPTERS

de la Cerda, Nicolás and Cecilia Martínez-Gallardo. 2022. “Mexico: A Politically Effective Populist Pandemic Response”. Book chapter in *Populists and the Pandemic: How Populists Around the World Respond to COVID-19*. Lucio Renno and Nils Ringe, eds. Routledge. Chapter 3, pages 29–43. DOI: [10.4324/9781003197614-3](https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003197614-3).

Bargsted, Matías, Sebastián Valenzuela, Nicolás de la Cerda and Bernardo Mackenna. 2013. “Participación ciudadana en las elecciones municipales 2012: diagnóstico y propuestas en torno al sistema de voto voluntario”. In Ignacio Irrarázaval, María de los Ángeles Morandé, and Magdalena Letelier (eds), *Propuestas para Chile*, chapter 1, pages 23–50.

WORK IN
PROGRESS

de la Cerda, Nicolás and Rodrigo Castro Cornejo. “Affective Clientelism: How Electoral Gift-Giving Cultivates Partisan Attachments and Electoral Support”.
– *Invited to revise and resubmit at Perspectives on Politics*.

de la Cerda, Nicolás, Isabel Laterzo, and Ayelén Vanegas. “Institutional Accountability and Support for Democracy: Evidence from a Natural Experiment”.
– *Invited to revise and resubmit at the British Journal of Political Science*.
– Covered in *Lawfare* (May 2025).

de la Cerda, Nicolás, Jonathan Hartlyn, Cecilia Martínez-Gallardo, and Eugenia Aguirre Raftacco. “The 2024 Chapel Hill Expert Survey – Latin America: Ideology, Populism, and Illiberalism”.
– *Invited to revise and resubmit at the British Journal of Political Science*.

de la Cerda, Nicolás. “Political Identities and Belief Networks in Comparative Perspective”.

– *Invited to revise and resubmit at Political Psychology.*

Argote, Pablo, Nicolás de la Cerda, and Giancarlo Visconti. “Thick and Thin Ideological Dimensions of Party Competition in Latin America”.

– *Under Review.*

Ascencio, Sergio, Rodrigo Castro Cornejo, and Nicolás de la Cerda. “The Founder’s Shadow: Party Institutionalization Under Charismatic Leadership”.

Bakker, Ryan, Nicolás de la Cerda, and Jonathan Polk. “Evaluating the Trade-offs in Expert Survey Sample Size”.

Cohen, Mollie J. and Nicolás de la Cerda. “Irregularity Accusations, Social Norms, and Electoral Perceptions in Peru”.

de la Cerda, Nicolás. “Beyond Partisanship: Theory and Methods”.

de la Cerda, Nicolás and Michael Greenberger. “The Institutions in our Heads: Prototypes and Trust in Political Institutions”.

DATA COLLECTION

Chapel Hill Expert Survey-Latin America (CHES-LA)

Principal Investigator (with Jonathan Hartlyn and Cecilia Martínez-Gallardo).
Expert Survey measuring party positions on ideological and non-ideological dimensions in Latin America.

– 2020-2021: Administered in 12 Latin American countries.

– 2024-2025: Administered in 18 Latin American countries.

Chapel Hill Expert Survey-United States (CHES-US)

Principal Investigator (with Ryan Bakker, Royce Carroll, Alexa Federice, and Christopher Hare).

Expert Survey measuring party positions on ideological and non-ideological dimensions in the United States.

– 2026: Data Collection in progress.

EXTERNAL AFFILIATIONS

Universidad Diego Portales, Santiago, Chile

Investigador Adjunto. Núcleo Milenio para el Estudio de la Política, Opinión Pública y Medios en Chile (MEPOP), *2025-present*

Instituto de Estudios Peruanos, Lima, Perú

Investigador Afiliado. *Summer 2022*

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2025 – Expense Support Grant. Institute for Humane Studies, George Mason University. (\$3,500)

2025 – Supporting Impactful Publications (SIP) Program. University Office of Academic Affairs and Provost, Tulane University. (\$2,500).

2025 – Stone Center Faculty/Staff Professional Travel Award. Stone Center for Latin American Studies, Tulane University. (\$800)

2025 – Postdoctoral Fellow Travel Fund. Office of Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies, Tulane University. (\$1,000)

2024 – Stone Center Faculty/Staff Professional Travel Award. Stone Center for Latin American Studies, Tulane University. (\$600)

2024 – Stone Center Faculty/Staff Professional Travel Award. Stone Center for Latin American Studies, Tulane University. (\$650)

2024 – Postdoctoral Fellow Travel Fund. Office of Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies, Tulane University. (\$500)

2024 – Mellon Conference Travel Award. Institute for the Study of the Americas, UNC-Chapel Hill. (\$500)

2023 – Uhlman Fellow. Department of Political Science, UNC-Chapel Hill. (\$3,275)

2023 – APSA First Generation Scholar Travel and Accessibility Grant. (\$145)

2023 – MPSA Graduate Student Travel Scholarship (\$500).

2022 – James W. Prothro Award for Outstanding Research, Best Graduate Student Paper. Department of Political Science, UNC-Chapel Hill. (\$675)

2022 – Carolina Latinx Center Innovation Award. Carolina Latinx Center, UNC-Chapel Hill.

2022 – Mellon Dissertation Award. Institute for the Study of the Americas, UNC-Chapel Hill. (\$3,000)

2022 – Summer Research Fellowship. Department of Political Science, UNC-Chapel Hill. (\$3,000)

2022 – Thomas F. Ferdinand Summer Research Fellowship. Graduate School, UNC-Chapel Hill. (\$5,000)

2021 – Summer Research Collaboratory Program. Department of Political Science, UNC-Chapel Hill. (\$5,000)

2020 – Graduate Research Award. Institute for the Study of the Americas, UNC-Chapel Hill. (\$1,500)

2020 – Uhlman Fellow. Department of Political Science, UNC-Chapel Hill. (\$2,250)

2020 – Pre-dissertation Field Research Grant. Institute for the Study of the Americas, UNC-Chapel Hill. (\$1,500) [Cancelled due to the COVID-19 pandemic].

2020 – John Frechione award support for lodging. Latin American Social and Public Policy Conference (LASPP) [Cancelled due to the COVID-19 pandemic].

CONFERENCE

PRESENTATIONS

American Political Science Association (APSA): 2023, 2024, 2025.

Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA): 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026.

Southern Political Science Association (SPSA): 2021, 2025, 2026.

Latin American Studies Association (LASA): 2023, 2024, 2025.

Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Conference (EPOV): 2025.

European Union Studies Association (EUSA): 2025.

Asociación Chilena de Ciencia Política (ACCP): 2023.

Seminario de Opinión Pública y Comportamiento Político (UC): 2024, 2025.
World Association for Public Opinion Research (WAPOR): 2015.

INVITED TALKS
AND SEMINARS

Universidad Carlos III de Madrid (virtual). July, 2025.
Duke/UNC Political Behavior Group. April, 2024.
University of Mannheim (MZES). February, 2024.

TEACHING
EXPERIENCE

University of New Mexico

Instructor

- Political Science 580: Introduction to Empirical Research (F2026)

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Instructor

- POLI 209: Analyzing Public Opinion (F2021)
- POLI 209: Analyzing Public Opinion (Summer I)
- POLI 130: Comparative Politics (S2021)

Teaching Assistant

- IDST 128L: Data Literacy Lab, Caitlin Smith (S2024)
- IDST 123L: Data Literacy Lab, Caitlin Smith (F2023)
- IDST 113L: Data Literacy Lab, Caitlin Smith (S2023)
- IDST 123L: Data Literacy Lab, Caitlin Smith (F2022)
- POLI 203: Race, Innocence, and the Decline of the Death Penalty, Frank R. Baumgartner (S2022)
- POLI 130: Comparative Politics, Rahsaan Maxwell (F2020)
- POLI 130: Comparative Politics, Ashley Anderson (S2020)
- POLI 130: Comparative Politics, Andrew Reynolds (F2019)

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile

Instructor

- SOL 107: Social Ethics (March-July, 2018)
- SOL 107: Social Ethics (March-July, 2017)
- SOL 100: Sociological Paradigms (March-July, 2016)
- SOL 107: Social Ethics (March-July, 2016)
- SOL 107: Social Ethics (March-July, 2015)

Teaching Assistant

- SOL (3070) Data Analysis (August-December, 2015)
- SOL (3000) Design and Analysis of Social Research (March-July, 2013)

Universidad Alberto Hurtado

Instructor

- Statistics II (March-July, 2016)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	Ekhos Consulting Firm (Chile) <i>Research Associate</i> March 2016 – June 2018 • Survey polling for political campaigns and private firms. • Political campaign consultant.
PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND ACTIVITY	Discipline: Referee: <i>American Journal of Political Science · Journal of Politics · British Journal of Political Science · Political Behavior · Political Psychology · European Journal of Political Research · Party Politics · Journal of Elections, Public Opinion & Parties · Political Research Quarterly · Government and Opposition · Latin American Research Review · Latin American Politics & Society · Journal of Politics in Latin America · Bulletin of Latin American Research · Canadian Journal of Latin American and Caribbean Studies · Colombia Internacional · Analyses of Social Issues and Public Policy</i> Latin American Studies Association (LASA): Latin American Political Institutions Section Board Council Member (2024-2026). Department: Speaker Series Coordinator, Center for Inter-American Policy and Research (2024-2026). Student Representative, Political Behavior Tenure Track Assistant Professor Search Committee (2023). Program Coordinator, Latin American Working Group, UNC (2019-2023). Comparative Politics Subfield Representative and Comparative Working Group Organizer, UNC-Political Science Department (2022-2023).
METHODS TRAINING	Ordinary Least Squares Regression · Generalized Linear Models · Hierarchical Models · Causal Inference · Measurement Models · Machine Learning · Bayesian Models
TECHNICAL SKILLS	Statistical computing in R, Stan, Python, and Stata; $\text{\LaTeX}$; Qualtrics
LANGUAGES	Spanish: Native English: Fluent

REFERENCES

Jonathan Hartlyn
K. J. Reckford Dist. Professor of Poli. Sc.
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
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Cecilia Martínez-Gallardo
Associate Professor of Political Science
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
cmg@email.unc.edu

Liesbet Hooghe
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Ryan Bakker
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rbakker@sharjah.ac.ae